WILLIAM WARREN
BANFF, ALBERTA

Sept.2Ist,

My dear Miss Nickell,

First, I suppose I must introduce myself for Mrs. Armstrong of Owen Sound perhaps did not understand what I meant when I wrote her a most verbose letter. The letter was really meant to send to you as I knew Mrs. A. would have scant interest in the sub. which I threshed thro from head to tail.

I am sorry I have not kept her letter but(you see I am Mary Schaffer Warren of small fame and less respect as to what that lady did just for the fun of it) she spoke of having you visit her and how you told her I was the one to "discover" Lake Maligne but the honor for same had gone to a man because I was a mere woman.

I suppose if I should wende r afield and told what I had done, it would sound rather extensive but I shall always assert that what I HAVE done, any other stupid could have accomplished as well. I do assert they could have done no better, for after all, the credit of our accomplishments lies entirely with the fine type of men who saw us thro sloughs and muskeg, swimming of rivers and getting out alive and all the other interesting things connected with wandering with our horses thro almost unknown country of that time.

As you have read Old Indian Trails, you will already know that we heard of a mystifying lake called Chaba Imne,heard thro Jim Simpson, and as Jim said:"You like going into unknown places, why not try to find this lake?" "Old Indian Trails", absolutely just that for there was no other governing power to get us anywhere. All thro the summer of I907 we wandered here and there, just hoping but got back to Saskatchewan Pl ains as ignorant as when we started out. There we were lucky in finding Silas Abraham and Sampson Beaver who had been the original informants to Jim S. of the unknown lake. Sampson must have trod the hills about this lake as a child while his elders were on the long hunts.

I approached him about it and asked him to draw me "how to get there"?(He did not speak one word of English.) He had a very shrewd eye and instantly cocking it at me, said:"What you pay me?" I was indignant enough and after all Indians are only tall children so I grew veryindignant telling him of the flour, tea, sugar, a dr dress for his little girl, a nice doll thrown in, that had come to his tepee and said very sharply:"Now draw me the picture of how to get there". He was quite sheepish and drew the way from Banff, up the Bow, etc till he landed us at the lake itself. Yes, I later tacked on a little more tea and sugar(everything was water-soaked then anyhow) and on one of our last evenings to-gether we all talked of finding this unknown lake. All the following winter it was the general sub. of conversation and many plans were made for the small details we would encounter. As a MAP, it held slight hopes but we did want to see something of which the Indians enthused over so much. The first hundred miles were easy f from long knowledge but when once on new ground, we never passed a dent in the hills, a seeming valley without exploring to see if the unknown might be there. Not once did we have to retrace our steps and if you have read the book and Syd. Unwin's vast climb, you will remember our coming out on the lake at its widest part (where incidentally one of our flour bags got dumped into the water)

This whole old story is written in the little book meant to encourage people to go camping, its ease if one's head is screwed on right, no real hardships and if one occur, so soon for-

gotten in some brighter joy of wild life. It was also written for my nephew, just at an age for "one more story, Aunt Mary, before I go to sleep". How he loved those mild tales and I never handle t the book without thinking of him. He sleeps since 1916, in some unknown spot on the Somme. A beautiful, brave boy, only 17 but the love of adventure his aunt always had.

The winter after we had re-located the lake my dear friend Mollie Adams and I were in Japan, Hokkaid, Formosa and a snip of China. She caught cold coming back to Japan and I left her sleeping in Kobi on the beautiful heights overlooking the Pacific, pneu monia from exposure on deck.

For something to do, I wrote the little book which cannot fail to show we had unearthed that beauty spot. I dedicated it to Mollie, the finest pal any woman could ever have had. In 1911 Dr. D.B.Dowling the coal surveyor, very well known in his profession wrote most insistently that I go forward and SURVEY that lake. All my life I have done those things I did not know how to do. I tried wriggling out of surveying a pond even, but dear Dr. kept up his insistence that I do it as I had found the spot. He made everything very clear even to my rather dumb brain and in due course in 1911 I came back from the lake with its name tied to it---Maligne--- and a map showing the lake to be 18 miles long.

When one is in unknown regions, it is the most natural thing to leave a name here and there that the workers may have dist inguishing spots to wh. to refer but as for putting names on with any idea of ever holding them, simply did not enter my calculation.

As we came into camp at Buffalo Prairie(Jasper now) my guide informed me Dr. Dowling was camping near and wished me to go and call. I was very weary from a long ride and went to bed instead. In a half hour the dear Dr. crawled into the tepee, we crawled from our beds and all sat as so many Indians discussing my find. He first asked:"Did you succeed in the survey?" "O yes, but I was almost 1/4th mile short at the end near the mouth of the river". "That makes no difference. Did you leave any names on any of the mts?" "O yes, we had to do that to know what we were talking about. But they will never get a chance to live". "Why is that?" "Well, you see Dr., I have wandered into so many unknown valleys, left names I loved for certain places(and because something would happen to cause names) but when asked to write me experiences for publication, I have always been told my names were not appropriate and after all, it matters very little".

I noted a change in Dr's face and he said:" If you have made your measurements, drafted your map, put the names on each peak or river, send the whole thing to Ottawa". It struck me rather oddly and I asked him what he had to do with it. He replied he was secy of the Geog. Board and he meant to have a lot to do with it. I sent in the details and heard nothing till I received word that another party had informed the Board that my names were very bad and he must be allowed to have full say about everything. They paid no attention to him so he went to the R.R.board and asked them to intervene. They behaved likewise. My chief piece of wickedness had been in giving the ~~outflow of the lake the~~ lake the name of the outflow which was "Maligne" probably named over 100 years before by some hunter or trapper of French descent.

To make doubly sure, I sent map, names, everything to the Royal Geog. Society and Dr. Scott Keltie wrote back that as the name of Maligne was already there, it was quite the most proper thing to do, to name the pass, the peak and the lake for the old name so long there. After such long meandering, I have the little book wh. shows we did re-locate the lake, somewhere in the Toronto archives must be my map which they drafted from the

WILLIAM WARREN
BANFF, ALBERTA

original and somewhere in the Royal Geog. Society must be my report of my summer work. This long rig-ma-role comes about as Mrs. Armstrong told me about your visit and then added:"She told me you discovered Maligne but alas, you are only a woman and I understand it is claimed by the male profession"----something to that effect. I am just writing you to ask if such a silly thing is possible. There are three different proofs that we unearthed a very old but very fine hunting ground of the Indians. I never claimed to have "discovered" it. I doubt if there is a spot in the world to DISCOVER. We merely re-located and mapped it. The only person who ever had the nerve(beyond the villain in the play)to ask me "how I dared to say I had discovered the lake", was Howard Palmer of London, Conn. or somewhere round there. I had known Howard quite well and thought him very nice as well as a good climber but to have him face me in that way was annoying to my tart and simple soul. I wrote right back to him and told him that when he could find a single line with my name attached that I had been "discovering" anything I would make a public apology to any Geog. he chose to mention. Never had another line from him.

Going into Columbia valley from the Athabaska side, seeing that superb mt. of same name, we spent a few days there and discussed names left by Dr. Collie and Mr. Stutfield. There was a prominent mt. wh. seemed to have no name whatever and as Mt. Alexandra lies on the south side of Columbia, I suggested we call this fine peak "Edw. VII" so he could be near Alexandra.

I hesitate to say who made the first climb on it, but at least when he came down he had tacked on it "King Edw". Now you know we are liable to have any number of King Edwards so I appealed to the Can Board that it belonged to Edw.VII and not any old Edw. atall. Dr. Dowling was gone and whoever is or was at the head of the board practically told me it was none of my business. So all the Edwards are now sticking to my special peak.

I am sorry to say it has long been a custom by certain folk to switch and change names to their heart's content. Lake Hector, known for over 50 years as such, became over night--Lake Wapta. Wapta in Stoney means"water" Now do agree it was sort of silly. I think they have changed dear, beautiful old Pinto lake to "Sunset". I think the Indians called it Pinto as it is of such varied color. Dear old Bear Creek which flows into the Sa Sask. is now Mistaya or some such. The offender said we had entirely too many Bear Creeks. To be sure with all my thousands of miles I have not run down one Bear Creek, and its like changing the baby's name in a family.

Are you interested, Miss Nickell, or have I bored you with something you may call a trifle? I have such beautiful memories of the work done by young Sam Allen of Phila. when he climbed and measured and named almost all the mts round Louise. No one to-day has the haziest idea of whom poor Sam is. He climbed in '92,'93 & '94, McArthur lake and O'Hara were all new till he went in there. Young, enthusiastic and brilliant, he wandered the hills with only an Indian and the final year--Walter Wilcox. Sam lost his reason in a gentle, quiet way from overwork at Yale and lives a lonely life to-day. I have his own notes and sometimes my heart aches when I read certain books which never give Sam credit or even speak his name.

Maybe Mrs. Armstron was wrong about anyone attempting to force false glory on Maligne. It had been a famous hunting ground hundreds of years ago and to-day it seems like a pet child of my

I do not mean to be silly about any of it, but its high time that so many of the dear old names should be let alone. It would make you dizzy if you knew how many things have gone awry.

No mountain was ever named for me. (Mrs. A. seems to think one was) Had Mr. Warren not given up his year's work to make us safe we would never have seen the lake unless to die in it. I suggested to Mollie"Lets call that double-headed peak for mr.W. he has been our salvation."

Hoping I shall hear from you, that you will understand all my long explanations and that after all its just because I love my hills that I write to ask you if someone is still knocking old nam names off for new.

Your unknown friend,

Mary Schaffer Warren

WILLIAM WARREN
BANFF, ALBERTA

Nov. 12th

Please return

My dear Unseen friend,

How easy it is for me to put the right date on this letter, but you have written just as one of my dear friend's might and as my desk must be cleared in a week, I feel I must send you something even if you have not time to read it. Please do. Yesterday marks one of my saddest times in life---the loss of the most wonderful nephew that could have been given me when he was two weeks old.

He left us in '16 just before his birthday (17) and scribbled 18 in the bottom of his shoes so he could say:"I am over 18". His dear mother held him up to me on my first examination of what I expected to be a very ruddy and squirming infant and instead he looked like something at least 3 months old, his big brown eyes staring at an auunt who grabbed him ~~kxm~~ up as her most precious possession when the pretty mother said:"He is half yours as you have none". After that I always had him 6 months till he felt the awful call while still so young.

He fell in the battle of the Somme still under 19. We never found him and to-day he would be 37. Its hard to believe but we keep his memory as bright as when he was here with us. Maybe I told you I wrote "Old Indian Trails" more for him than anything else for all the foolish little tales were for him in his almost babyhood.

You will be amused at the importance you put on my name which after all leaves me quite cold except that you have passed on kind words. A prophet certainly must go to another land if he wants any praise. I am one of those prophets. My dear, reading your letter, I wish you might have been with me in 1908 when we saw that lovely lake in all its glory. The best part of it was its virgin soil, a sense that I was alone but for the dear ones who were with me. This talk of being "first" in any spot is very silly from my outlook. I was NEVER first. I think I told you I had seen signs of whites and Indians aplenty, but I fancy no one had been at Maligne for at least 30 years. That is only a guess but it was so silent, so clear of the ravages of strangers, animals galore, but still that quiet peace which hordes always make my heart ache so. O its cruel to think a chalet should be where our ponies used to browse!

I no longer know many of the REAL guides. I can see that you know the actual article--a man who knows how to manage his pack, his camp and all that goes with Nature herself and none of the present flummery of which the C.P.R. is unaware. How it does delight me that you sat about the camp-fire and read the little book which was meant to help those who did not know the way, how easy camp life might be, etc. OUR evenings were so often spent in writing up our diaries, never forg getting to mention where the insidious muskegs were, etc. Didn't you love my Pinky? Quite a prominent writer of Chicago told me once I made my horses very unreal as they had very little sense. He inflamed my natural modesty(HM) and I told him not to mention such things to those who KNEW horses for they would see how excessively ignorant h he was about the Indian Pony. They do not LOOK much but their dainty feet are the essence of safety. The one time we met Dr. Coleman he had a superb bunch of animals but they were too fine for their work. They do need to be very much onto their business of understanding deep ravines or high mountains. I well recall the slidy hill-sides along the baby Fraser. I could never have WALKED those nasty slopes but Nibs knew his k job and so did the rest of our unbeautiful but loving bunch.

Do you, hones t to goodness, fail to remember who else "Discovered"Maligne? I know two who would have enjoyed biting my head off because I CHANCED to get there after much trouble. When I went

at dear Dr. Dowling's suggestion to survey the lake in 1911, we did it with an utterly home-made boat, made right on the lake, and done w ith log and compass. The Otto brothers of Jasper at that time took me and my sister and nephew in. They were wonderful water-men fr. New Brunswick I think. They live at Jasper. When we returned to Buffalo Prairie, learned Dr.D. was camping very near, I learned later I had absolutely infuriated a certain GENTLEMAN for getting in there ahea of him. First I did not know he was going and second he made a fine detour round Mt. Hardisty to keep out of my sight. I have laid my congestures very closely to him for he has always been enraged that a mere woman could find her way in --and--survey that glorious lake.

When I met him(accidentally I assure you) the next spring, he asked me what length I had made the lake and on replying"18 miles", he said:"All wrong, its only 17 miles". I smiled like the cat at the cream andreplied:"You perhaps did not go far enough to see the FOOT at the end of the lake and where my lovely Pixey Valley is". Dr. Dowling told me later many a good piece of surveying had been done which was no better than mine. Well, if it was good, its all to the credit of my dear Dr. Jim Simpson is one of the REAL men of our hills. He is clever, a splendid marksman and a marvelous guide. What evenings we have spent about the camp-fires and when he tells you a thing he never stretches anything, is just a natural gentleman.

Can you use any effort to bring Pinto lake back to its original name? Cannot Dr. Colemen show sufficient indignation against such barbarity? These re-named places are OUR'S and I feel we have f first rights. Pinto is so lovely with its colors around the edge of the lake. Yes, Pinto is exactly at the foot of Mt.Coleman and this is the first time I knew my old friend had been responsible for the name. I had thought it was owing to such change of color that it had been thus called. The strangers who are going into our Paradise valleys, put things just where they please. Since Dr. Dowling died, I have been politely told not to interfere.

Can you realize I had the honor to meet Dr. Collie? He was out at Glacier with Mr. Stutfield. They climbed a great deal about th there. They weretwo deli htful men/ Neither of them bragged one b bit about their accomplishments. This summer I had to listen to a woman boasting her husband was the first person to climb Sir Donald. Collie and Stutfield must have been at Glacier about 91(a guess) and this fat man sneaked out at three a.m. about '98 with Edw. Feuz, Sr. I think he returned to Glacier about 6 p.m. and then tooted his accomplishment. His figure was against him to say the least. It was an unbelievable performance. So Mary Schaffer, having the curiosity of her sex as well as her general knowledge of the man, walked over to the guides' cottage and plainly asked Edward if the man had re really done it. I shall never forget his Swiss accent and his manner. He stared at me and slowly said:"Its not so hard, I could take a dead man up and down too". I felt I had a complete answer to my question.

I have not one of Collie's books here but if not the first, at least very close to it. Its a gorgeous mountain. I must tell you how my idol fell the first time I saw him. We all talked"Dr. Collie" and of co rse were all eyes to meet him. O what an awful blow he gave us without knowing it. He had a hole in his stocking as big as a dollar and how the adorer did want to darn it for him. I was pretty young at that time---to-day I would have boldly offered him that help. I do not know which is Mt. Weed, probably not named the days I was there. "Coleman"could not be mistaken. DO ask the dear Dr. to use his influence to have Pinto put where it belongs.

Tell Dr. Weed for me I may be somewhat younger than he, but I never climbed a mountain in my life except Wilcox. We were at 80000 ft when we started and I did nothing but grumble from the start. I hate climbing.

WILLIAM WARREN
BANFF, ALBERTA

Why do something with your heart in your mouth all the time? Ride? I would go with an Indian pony any place, swim, jump or follow my beloved Nibs when I was snow-blind, over Cataract Pass, but preserve me from climbing.

I knew almost all the great climbers, because I went as a very young bride to my loved hills. Did you ever know Sam Allen of Phila. discovered what is now known as Moraine lake, found McArthur and O'Hara while Tom Wilson named Schaffer for my first husband. Sam located The valley of Ten peaks and with two exceptions they are all changed? Its just vandalism. Sam was very brilliant. Did very fine work and did it because he loved it. He could learn a language in about th three months. In 1896 or 7 his mind refused to act. A boy climbing with him, issued a book in which he was the hero. Lake Wenkchemna became Moraine lake is not morainal atall, as some scientists pr proved when they were thro here several years ago. Those scientists came and went and I did not know it, but I retain a few wits whi which would have worked over-time had I been able to join them.

Its very hard to be just a SORT of scientist. It was lovely of you to say you would like to see me, etc. The people about here, I feel sure., think I am a dub. Do come and see me wh when you are next within our borders. I simply love anyone who loves my hills or my darling Mrs. Armstrong. Did she nearly get her head talked off her and tell you about it? Sh e was suffering from an accident to her spine and as I did not propose to talk too much about her accident, I took the field and the platform and talked at least an hour of my trip among the Head-hunters of Formosa, my visit to the Ainus of Hokkaido and my wonderful friend who died last year--dear Dr. Inazo Bitobe. She had the s sweet tendency of telling me I had made a nice hour for her. I do love her. She is a very superior woman and knows how to take her sorrows as we all should. I shall be writing her to-morrow and tell her what a charming letter her friend wrote and how I will wait to see and hear you and all you have done.

My door will be open to you any time you come and I MEAN it. If dear Dr. Colemen remebers me, do tell him he has been in my thoughts many times since his brother entered our tent(in a snowstorm) and seeing two females, wanted to know if there were any men about. I wish I had a copy of my child(Old Indian Trails) for you but alas, they can only be found at some auction mart.

With hearty greetings,

May Warren

WILLIAM WARREN
BANFF, ALBERTA

April IIth

Dear Miss Nichell,-

When you open the envelope, out will pop a clipping which will surely be more or less familiar to you. We arrived home from the West Indies just a week ago to-day and tho there was a certain amt of snow, it looked very good to my over-heated nerves and body generally. I am far from in love with any hot climate whatever and being forced, owing to boat connection, we were planted in Kingston, Jamaica for five intolerably long weeks.

Every short drive took us thro Spanish Town which was the old capitol of the island and of course years ago, everyhting radiated fr. that(at present) awful centre. There is a marvelously attractive cathedral there and all the high dignitaries of hundreds of years ago, a are planted down the aisle of the church, under some of the pews and generally scattered about till I felt like a complete apology to the dead. You see I am not accustomed to going places where one tramps on the departed and I confess I did step lightly, it seemed so sad, even tho I know they have been enduring it for many centuries.

The town itself is beyond description. It has gone completely native and that is saying the worst one can think of. Thatched houses I should imagine, would engender things a body would not care to meet in polite society and tho I saw thousands of these squalid homes, I was never brave enough to see how they looked from the inside. The sts. were full of workmen strolling home from banana fields as well as cane field. Chickens were beyond counting and always in the middle of the road. The roosters were destitute of feathers about their necks, the latter looking like raw beef and as tho just emerging from a fight. Nannie goat and their infants helped to swell the crowd of inhabitants while donkeys were as numerous as the roosters. There is no doubt that the Jamaicans believe in absolute fertilisation, tho both you & I know a non fertile egg is better than the other. The strangest thing about said roosters is that they seem to crow all day, take couple of hours off in early night and start where they left off about I a.m. They then make night hideous right on to 8 a.m. This racket goes on all over the island. So if I was undertaking any sort of missionary work, it would be to teach Jamaicans that one rooster would do where IOO now exist. It has been years since I have met so numerous a lot of English folk who impress any American, Canadian, or any sort of nationality that they are a superior race, the only folk who speak PURE English and no hesitancy in telling you about your faults.

Speaking of roosters I was promptly corrected by an English woman who said"only Americans would say "rooster, they should say cocks" I was quite filled already with her lofty airs so solemnly said:"If you go to the States or Canada, speak gently if you say cock, the word is rather coarse to our uneducated ears. We seldom mention rams, bulls stallions, etc.and certainly not COCK". There was a time when this stripe of English came across the country and we were very able to let them alone, but in the present instance we were all hived in a smallish hotel. Our Supt's wife was telling me that a few days ago she had to entertain a New Zealander who told her she could not endure the accnet of Americans or Canadians. My friend has rather a broad Scot Scotch accent and I suggested that had saved her.

Many of these sensitive people had come to a black man's country to try and make a living, tho the "cock" lady was there dodging the income tax of England. One gilr who sat behind me in the patio here we all ate, I overheard saying to a man with an accent

you could cut:"I am pleasantly surprised at the Americans. They are not nearly so dirty as I expected. I can get a good bath in a basin or a bucket, but they must have bath-rooms". I assure you I was not conceited enough to think she was firing a broadside at me at the time but later learning she had gone to Jamaica to obtain work as an entertainer, movie work or concert work,that she was living in what we would call a "hall bed-room" and that we had a glorious room with four windows, a bath that had 2 taps in it from one of which always ran real hot water. This we found in due course was a great exception. We always asked for baths, had the fun of paying for them, tho nothing but cold water could be squeezed from them. With the European war conditions such as they are, everyone who wants to flee the cold, struck for the West Indies. They came by the thousand and the docks were always filled.

Our trips into the mountains were very interesting(after we learned to carry some warm clothing with us.) I very nearly contracted pneumonia at one of the higher places and fled back to the intensive heat where I was very much run down. We both think that California will be preferable another year. I have simply reveled in the mountain air for which I was certainly norn. It has been very cold here for quite a time, but to-day, tho cloudy, it is up in the 50s and I hope the snow will have been quite quenched on this mountainside.

My goodness!!! I have just opened your letter to see what you had written and the first sentence is that you are thinking of the West Indies. I had no idea I was tramping on your hopes when speaking of the land we have left behind us. I never saw a therm. all the time we were there, it was bad enough to know I was sick with heat and moisture but I heard someone ask my husband about the heat. He replied it was abt. IOI in the middle of the day. If you really think of going, do try & get your trip arranged for boat connection with the islands. We had to spend our five weeks right in Jamaica or would have missed our boat. There was no hopping from island to island. If you get to OUR island, I have no hesitation in saying to go to Grenville Hotel in Kingston. It is owned and run by Miss Farquharson. Any taxi man would drop you at her place. Her baths are noted for having hot water. You would perhaps like Mandeville. It was so frightfully damp when we were there that I fled before my bronchitis got beyond repair. Mandeville is quite up in the hills, many quaint old English families, there and I believe the grass always green. The best and cheapest hotel is called the Mandeville, I think and I know its run by a Mr. Evelyn; No hot water. Excepting Myrtle Bank and Constant Springs hotels(wh. are regular banditries for tourists,I do think Miss Farquharosons the best place of any. Non't expect a thing of Montego Bay. As a friend described the beach,"it can be covered by a postage stamp." It is a very small beach of very white sand. From the noise I would suggest no lady go alone to Dr.s Cave or Csa Blanca. Beach View, on the opposite side of the road is pleasantly run by a Mr. Aarons. No hot water.

Another thing if you enter OUR city, always take the little one-horse train to Mandeville, to Montego, etc. The inhabitants try to make the newcomer take taxis anywhere and run down the train which is nothing to look at but nothing like as bad as they tell you. Always ask your fare to any place where you must drive. I shilling is the true price fr boat to hotel. You have to watch the native or he will have your eye teeth before you are in that island aday. We read all the ads. we could before we left, even Sir Algernon Aspinall's book--price $3.50 and a book of false impressions.it was. Of course I do not account for any other island but we knew a man who got stuck as we did at St. Thomas and he said he nearly died of monotony. Michael Delahany of Montreal runs Marine Hotel of Barbados and should you get there, I know Michael would be nice to you. He was in the service of C.P.R. for a long time but as is usual, his head came off just when he had his hotel out here going splendidly. I am sending you the sketch which came out last night in the Calgary Herald. You will note that Mr. McLeod is spoken of as having been into the lake in '75.

WILLIAM WARREN
BANFF, ALBERTA

You can see how he no doubt was there and if he is living he also would like to claim the lake as his. Have you any idea who W.J.Banks. B.A. could be or where we could catch him? So far as I can make out, I don't think anyone can claim it.(the lake) Our little party may be said to have brought it back to the light of day. After Mrs. Armstrong wrote me of a man claiming the lake as his, I had my eagle eye on one party in particular and I was determined he should not take THAT spot of glory from me as he did so many other places.

Is Dr. Collie still living? He was a charming man. I never came across Mr. Weed. He was climbing with Mr. Sutfield when I knew him. Did I tell you the shock Collie gave me on hearing the fine climber was returning to Glacier House. He walked in and had an AWFUL HOLE IN THE HEEL OF HIS STOCKING! When I named a mt. "Edw. VII" directly north of Mt. Columbia and draining into the Athabaska eventually, I wrote Dr. Collie to ask him if that might be Mt. Alberta or was it still unnamed. He wrote back such a quizzical letter telling me that when he named Columbia, the Twins, etc., the haze was so dense he could never be sure. I found the name in an article by Howard Palmer of London, Conn. in which he called it "King Edw." By that time my dear old friend Dr.D.B.Dowling was dead so I wrote to the Pres. of the Geog. of Canada. Do you know him? I have one tremendous impression of him and his letters, he practically told me to mind my own affairs and "King Edw." would stand.

I wrote Mrs. Armstrong at once on getting home. As she brought us to-gether, I think she may like some of the odds and ends I have put down here, specially my throwing cold water on the West Indies. Maybe you do not mind heat, it almost kills me, I come out so exhausted. I kept pretty quiet--for me-- when Jamaica was threshed over. I never have stood heat, but owning an exceptionally fine husband who needed something else than 40 below zero, I said nothing and I really believe he did most of the squeeking. He knew without much explanation that I was done for most of the time. He has just been saying:"We must profess to have liked Jamaica" and I replied I did not think it worth fibbing about. I shall wait to hear what your plans are after giving you such terrible details before opening your letter for reply.

Would you send this up to her? I have spent many an hour telling her some of our experiences and when a body has to be thinking about aches and pains all the time, she may find something over which to smile. I have missed so many of the years of her life, grew to love her almost from the first moment I set eyes on her and shall love her dearly while life lasts.

Sincerely your friend,

Mary Warren

Banff, Dec. 13th,

Dear Miss Nickell,

I started to send you just a card but having a good two hours on hand I just thought I would have a chat instead. You make me feel I have known you for ages. Its four weeks on next Thursday since my husband went off like akite to pay his respects to the Portland Clinic in Portland Oregon. Not being a lady of much nerve ever since I had a bad motor accident, I don't think I ever knew four such awful weeks. And now that I know he expects to be back in Banff to-morrow evening, I am more jittery than ever. I have not dared to invite too many in just a very few at a time and my whole heart all the time with this man of mine unable to tell me a thing.

Blessed are those women who can follow their own inclinations, do as they please, never think a second time of the other fellow. I have been ill so much the past 6 years that to have my husband out of sight simply makes me ill. When my first husband died I simply had to dash i into anything I could to avoid the loneliness and that is how I managed to get out my botany. Gathering plants, painting and photographing did an enormous amt. for me, but to-day I have only an article at present to write. You may have know Julia Henshaw who passed away recently. She had watched my husband at his work but I did not know she meant to take it up. After he died, she began her work. I think it came to the public eye about a year before mine was rady. I am not a botanist and employed the botanist of the Acad. Nat. Sciences of Phila. He was a well-recognised man and thus I avoided many a blunder.

My work was painting, photoing, etc, while he did the brain work. I also did the collecting but what I did, almost anyone could do, so he got all the glory that could come to him. He was a fine man and REAL botanists say his work is excellent. He died a few years ago. But his work was recognised. Its a strange so called thing---scientist.

My Father, my first husband and about all their friends led a life amidst the varied sciences. All I could was to fall in behind and do all the admiring. I thought the most wonderful thing of beauty was a water-lily. Nearly lost my life out canoeing one day at Toronto, trying to reach for a lily to carry in to afamous botanist. I cannot recall her name for the moment, but her real work was mosses and other tiny water plants. With the greatest triumph I carried the lily and its long stem into the hotel where we were all staying and meekly handed the beautiful thing to her. She took a pathetic look at it and said:"You had better keep it for my mind is entirely engaged with a much higher type of plant life". I was not offended or hurt, I was just plain MAD. Going up to my room I opened up on Dr.Schaffer who had a fearful time explaining to me what she meant. But no explanation ever overcame my bitterness that a woman could be a marvelous botanist and see no beauty in one of the finest things in the world. To her I was simply what I truly was-----a feather-weight and have thus remained.

You s e, dear Miss Nickell, I learned very earlywhat a lot of so-called science is nothing whatever. It has been rather hard for me to hear entirely too good words when I know so well, how very flippant life truly is and only the VERY few have risen to true heights.

Our mountain hill-side is now in a precarious condition. We have had very little cold and to-day it is almost warm. The snow melts and then the falls begin to start. Can you imagine what it means to have snow-wreaths all over t e higherhills. Three miles from here my car can get into such gorgeous beauty and its fairy-land till we reach a point where its well to turn back. The meadows are dotted almost all t e time with Moose, Elk, a c coyote skimming his way under the spruces. The elk are here in thousands and I never saw such an abundance of moose on this side of the Divide.

I envy you your trip to Jack Miner's place. He must be truly interesting. I just saw by the paper that the man who has made friends with beaver, is in London to show how he works with his beaver. He mentions in one place that the beaver, alas, are almost gone and he hopes to keep a few alive. Well, that part of his explanation, needs a lot of overhauling. He has probably never been west so he remains unaware of the fact that we would be only too glad to send him quite a batch. Our swamps and slews are alive with the little beasts. The poplars are being gnawed out of existence. Our once lovely valleys are being drowned out andwe are fast becoming swampy deserts.

Your visit to Henry Ford's place must have been thrilling but I fear I have small time for Father Coughlan8s work. I know at one time the Catholic Church told Coughlan he could no longer radio. It seems to take such small incentive to start those who have but little, to hand out the few pennies they have. Right here in Alberta we are being hounded by one---Aberhart. He is our minister and his work is nothing short of very bad. He keeps everything as MONEY. He talks money and the quotes the bible. We are in a bad state at present with slight chance of getting back to normal. I wonder if you are a n admirer of Nellie McClung. She lives now in Vancouver ---when she is home---tho I think she travels a great deal.

The first thing I ever sawof her's was:"Sowing Seeds in Danny". It struck me as a rather bright bit but not anything more than just clever. Very soon after that she called on me to make enquiries on my own knowledge and said she was calling on literary people. This is quite a time ago and I remember saying I did not know there were any clever people in Banff and very few anywhere. I was f forced in a few moments to say I was anything but clever because she had looked above my fireplace and asked me why I kept Mr. R.B.Bennett's picture beside a very beautiful mirror. Politics or no politics, Mr. B. and I are life-long friends and he is equally fond of my husband. I have had g great cause to worship him for his goodness to me in the year gone by and his goodness to many more. We all have likes and dislikes and Nellie did not endear herself to me by speaking her own thoughts. Thus our friendliness never

advanced any further. I am interested in your summing of Bedoux. Work should have made a practical man of him and in some of the writing, he IS practical. Its beyond me, for I do not even understand his motives and his ideals.

As for our poor Duke, I knew him at odd times out here in Banff. There seemed much to condemn but had any of us a right to do the condemning? Silence seemed our only weapon of defense. He was our Prince a then our King. As such he seemed beyond criticism. We who lived where he came so much among us, never said a wo word for which I feel very grateful. I saw plenty to c criticise but I never heard one word from a soul about here. Then he ascended the throne, the throne his father had made so perfect. His poor mother begged him to change and the woman said frankly she would never interfere in his work. She kept no law or promise.

I often feel there is much that some day will be told and if so, she will be t rribly condemned. It was a positive relief when I heard the U.S. would not receive her. I don't feel she is any worse than many ot thers, except that she should have held a high position and she failed where it would have meant nothing to other It was a terrible tragedy to everyone. But one may go on hoping for better things from those who took on the troublous times and must bear them to the end. I had a grand annoyance a few days ago fro a cousin in the States. He did not hesitate to assert that Edw. was the finest man yet, and the lady quite his equal. For good measure the cousin said the British would never pay their war debts. I have many things in mind on that sub. I have started to write to easte Canada regarding the fact that the U.S. never paid her ow debts to England when she borrowed so profusely during 861--65. The U.S. never allows herself to feel annoyance because she is always right. I think I can get that datat if only to tell ONE man about it.

I am not favoring Abe hart in any way but is he much worse than the conceit of our counrty neighbors? I do not seem to remember that you rode to Maligne via our own route and what fun you must have had reading my r rather silly book. Of course I love it, because it was s so filled with private personalities. Very little of t whole ever showed and we dare not say too many things. But to us, it was a great trip--this seeking for unknown land and lake. I do appreciate Mis Ryley saying such kind things and I would love to meet her again. I wonder if Dr. Collie is still living. I met him at Glacier and he had a hole in his stocking but he was a wonderul man. I remember his having Mr. Stutfield with him--both exceptional, but I was GREEN while they were marvelously clever. I do not recall meeting Mr. Wedd. So you went with Fred Br Brewster on one of your trips. I believe his brother Jack has much less education and far more knowledge of conditions in the wlds. He has a lovely wife. I met the woman who was to marry Fred, while he was still

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overseas. I do not think she is dead but so far as I do know she is quite out of her mind. I think she is in a sanitarium. She was very strange from the first time I saw her. There are some very fine guides around Jasper men who are unbeatable. The Brewster family is entirely different. When one has lived a long life among the hills, one knows who the great and near-great are.

Mary Jobe called on me this summer. I think she attaches "Dr." to her name now. In a large way she was very handsome. She did not permit me to ask what she meant to do, perhaps she will just do things as they come along. I have written you a crazy letter. In fact my mind is VERY much on my husband's home-coming. I am just finishing this on his day of arrival. We have never been separated before since our marriage. I am praying his health will be vastly improved.

He took me into the hills because he would not let me go with the average man. In reality he is a very fine business man and has injured his health thus.

I should like you to know him, but he is one of those silent Englishmen who does such a pile of thinking.

I am enclosing a small card which speaks for me.

Your friend, Mary Warren

Pioneer of Banff, Mrs. Warren, Dies

Banff (Special) — Banff lost one of its most respected old-timers, when Mrs. William Warren passed away at her home last evening. Coming West 35 years ago with her husband, Dr. Schaeffer, a well-known botanist, they traveled and explored many trails around Banff, Lake O'Hara, Glacier and Jasper. Mount Schaeffer in the O'Hara district stands in memory of their work. Dr. Schaeffer died in 1908, and in 1913 Mrs. Schaeffer moved permanently to Banff. During the war she married William Warren, who had been her chief guide in the Rockies. Mrs. Warren is credited with being the first white woman to glimpse the beautiful lake in Jasper and called it Maligne Lake.

She also illustrated a book on wild flowers of the Canadian Rockies that was published after Dr. Schaeffer's death, and she wrote and illustrated books describing old Indian trails in the Rockies.

H. H. Sharples of Calgary, and Fred Sharples of Westbury, are brothers.

A private funeral service will be held tomorrow morning and interment will be in Banff. [1939]

BENNY TRIAL POSTPONED